

The Noble Dhāraṇī, King of Wisdom-Mantras, Supreme Lamp

Ārya-agrapradīpa-dhāraṇī-vidyārāja · Toh 528 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྟེན་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་པ་སྒྲོམ་མཆོག་གི་ཟུང་ས།

Toh 528 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-agrapradīpa-dhāraṇī-vidyārāja and in Tibetan as the Phakpa Rik Ngak Kyi Gyalpo Drönma Chok Gi Zung, rendered in English as "The Noble Dhāraṇī, King of Wisdom-Mantras, Supreme Lamp." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a sacred dhāraṇī — a ritual formula of protective and spiritual power — framed within a classic sūtra setting in which the Buddha teaches at Śrāvastī surrounded by monks, gods, and bodhisattvas. The text introduces a distant buddha-field called Boundless Flowers, where another buddha currently dwells and teaches, situating the dhāraṇī within a vast, cosmologically expansive vision of multiple awakened beings active throughout the universe. As a vidyārāja, or "king of wisdom-mantras," the dhāraṇī is presented as possessing supreme efficacy, placing this work among the canonical collections that blend Mahāyāna doctrinal vision with the practical transmission of powerful mantric formulas.

In the language of India: Ārya-agrapradīpa-dhāraṇī-vidyārāja. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī, King of Wisdom-Mantras, Supreme Lamp.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great Saṅgha of one thousand two hundred and fifty monks, along with many hundreds of thousands of gods and humans, and many hundreds of thousands of bodhisattvas. Surrounded by them all and facing them, he was teaching the Dharma.

Beyond this buddha-field, past one trillion buddha-fields, there is a world-system called Boundless Flowers. In that world there presently dwells, lives, abides, and teaches the Dharma a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and fully awakened buddha by the name of Supreme Lamp. That buddha sent two bodhisattvas, named Great Light and Amitābha, to this world-system of Endurance.

Then those two bodhisattvas went to where the Blessed One was in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, and approached the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Śākyamuni. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times, and sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, those two bodhisattvas addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, beyond a hundred trillion buddha-fields there is a world-system called Boundless Flowers. In that world there presently dwells, lives, abides, and teaches the Dharma the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha called Supreme Lamp. That Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Supreme Lamp, has sent us two to this world-system of Endurance."

They also conveyed these inquiries on his behalf: "Does the Blessed One have few ailments, few afflictions? Is he vigorous? Does he live in comfort, with strength and ease, abiding in the absence of harm?"

And they further said: "Are there here no humans or non-humans, spirits, flesh-eaters, yakṣas, rākṣasas, kumbhāṇḍas, leaders of kumbhāṇḍas, kings, great ministers, thieves, serpents, insects, worms, iron-file insects, or any near-afflictions whatsoever that might cause harm to us?"

And they said: "For the welfare of sentient beings, for their healing and happiness, for the bestowal of radiance and splendor, of fame, of good qualities, of strength and of fine complexion, and for their protection, shelter, and refuge, that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Supreme Lamp, has also sent these root dhāraṇī mantras, as follows:

gvāle gvāle gvāle gate hukku mukku saṃmate mahāsaṃmate mahāgvāle
gvābalame sahe sahe mahāgvāle ukke mukke śame saṃmahe mahāsaṃmahe
mahāśame svāhā.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up these root mantras, master them, and hold them!"

master them, and proclaim them widely to others as well. Ānanda, the arising of a buddha is rare. These root dhāraṇī mantras are rare to find. Ānanda, those who hold these root dhāraṇī mantras are exceedingly rare indeed. Ānanda, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family holds, receives,

retains, recites, masters, and proclaims widely to others these root dhāraṇī mantras — such a person will, for seven lifetimes, recall their past lives. And in this very life as well, apart from previously accumulated karma, they will pass beyond all harm caused by others and become harmoniously attuned to all beings. Ānanda, these root dhāraṇī mantras were spoken by seven hundred and seventy million buddhas. Whoever transgresses these root dhāraṇī mantras has deceived every single one of them.

Then the great bodhisattva (bodhisattva mahāsattva) Ajita rose from his seat, draped his robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, turned toward the Blessed One with palms pressed together in reverence, and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, I too, for the benefit of sentient beings, for their healing and happiness, for the bestowal of radiance and splendor, of fame, of good qualities, of strength and of fine complexion, and for their protection, shelter, and refuge, will proclaim these root dhāraṇī mantras, as follows:

atte btte natte kunatte pukkase kupukkase kase anakase nāmakase anutu pranutu khaje mahākhaje satpappe taḍappe tuḍappe hilimilile svāhā.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up these root dhāraṇī mantras, master them, hold them, master them fully, and proclaim them widely and correctly to others as well. Ānanda, the arising of a buddha is rare. These root dhāraṇī mantras are rare to find. Ānanda, those who hold these root dhāraṇī mantras are exceedingly rare indeed. Ānanda, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family holds, receives, retains, recites, masters, and proclaims widely to others these root dhāraṇī mantras — such a person will, for twelve lifetimes, recall their past lives. And in this very life as well, apart from previously accumulated karma, they will pass beyond all harm caused by others and become harmoniously attuned to all beings. Ānanda, these root dhāraṇī mantras were spoken by eight hundred and twenty million buddhas. Whoever transgresses these root dhāraṇī mantras has deceived every single one of them.

Then Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, rose from his seat, draped his robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, turned toward the Blessed One with palms pressed together in reverence, and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, I too, for the benefit of sentient beings, for their healing and happiness, for the bestowal of radiance and splendor, of fame, of good qualities,

for the bestowal of power, for the bestowal of radiant complexion, for protection, for shelter, and for refuge, I shall now recite these root dhāraṇī mantras. They are as follows: Akke, Bakke, Najite, Nāgāsare, Nahili, Jahili, Jahilivate, Caṇḍīlavate svāhā.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up these root dhāraṇī mantras, retain them, learn them, master them fully, and teach them extensively to others as well. Ānanda, the appearance of a buddha in the world is rare. These root dhāraṇī mantras are rare. And, Ānanda, even one who holds these root dhāraṇī mantras is exceedingly rare. Ānanda, whatever son or daughter of good family holds, takes up, bears, reads, masters fully, and teaches extensively to others these root dhāraṇī mantras will recall their past lives for thirteen lifetimes. In this very life, too, apart from previously accumulated karma, they will pass entirely beyond all harm caused by others, and they will come to be in harmony with all beings. Ānanda, these root dhāraṇī mantras were spoken by eight hundred and twenty million buddhas. Whoever transgresses these root dhāraṇī mantras has deceived every single one of them."

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks: "Monks, I too, for the benefit of sentient beings, for their healing and happiness, for the bestowal of radiance, of splendor, of fame, of good qualities, of power, of fine complexion, for protection, for shelter, and for refuge, shall now expound these root dhāraṇī mantras. They are as follows: Aṭṭhe, Baṭṭhe, Naṭṭhe, Kunaṭṭhe, Ṭake, Eḍake, Tatave, Tuḍave, Raṭake, Lole, Hule, Hili, Mile, Tile, Śīle, Śīla, Aḍhe, Baḍhe, Naḍhe, Kunaḍhe, Aḍavtī, Panavtī, Kase kase kase, Phase phase phase, Mahāphase phase svāhā.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up these root dhāraṇī mantras, retain them, learn them, master them fully, and teach them extensively to others as well. Ānanda, the appearance of a buddha in the world is rare. These root dhāraṇī mantras are rare. And, Ānanda, even a teacher of these root dhāraṇī mantras is exceedingly rare. Ānanda, whatever son or daughter of good family holds, takes up, bears, reads, masters fully, and teaches these root dhāraṇī mantras extensively to others will recall their past lives for fourteen lifetimes. In this very life, too, apart from previously accumulated karma, they will pass entirely beyond all harm caused by others, and they will come to be in harmony with all beings. Ānanda, these root dhāraṇī mantras were spoken by eight hundred and forty million buddhas. Whoever transgresses these root dhāraṇī mantras has deceived every single

one of them.

Whatever sons or daughters of good family guard, thoroughly protect, thoroughly hold, bind, and pacify these root dhāraṇī mantras on dry, unseasoned wood,

and when they have made it well and whole, that very tree will put forth shoots and leaves, and flowers and fruits too will come into full manifestation — how much more so for a human being!

Namaḥ sarvabuddhebhyaḥ. Siddhantu dhāraṇī. Mantrapādani svāhā.

Then the Blessed One addressed the monks once more: Monks, for the sake of sentient beings — for their benefit, happiness, radiance, majesty, renown, excellence, strength, and good complexion, and in order to guard, shelter, and protect them — other root dhāraṇī mantras shall also be taught. They are as follows:

Atte matte pake pāraḥ peke dā dramatī taramatī ṭṭamaṭi ṭṭamaṭi ṭṭaṭure sure hile mule tile svāhā.

Then the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda: Ānanda, you should receive these root dhāraṇī mantras, learn them, retain them, recite them, master them fully, and teach them extensively to others as well. Ānanda, it is rare to encounter the appearance of a buddha. These root dhāraṇī mantras are rare to encounter. And those who hold these root dhāraṇī mantras are rarer still to find.

Ānanda, whatever sons or daughters of good family receive, take up, retain, recite, master fully, and also teach these root dhāraṇī mantras extensively to others will recall their past lives for twenty-one lifetimes. In this very life too, apart from previously accumulated karma, they will pass entirely beyond all harm caused by others, and they will come to be in harmony with all beings.

Whoever is protected by these mantras cannot be overcome by any elemental spirit whatsoever — not by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, great serpents, humans, or any non-human being. They cannot be overcome by snakes, insects, spiders, or any venomous flies. They cannot be overcome by any epidemic winds, bile disorders, phlegm disorders, combinations of these, or any illness arising from the change of seasons. Whether a fever lasting one day, two days, three days, four days, seven days, half a month, one month, a year, or a prolonged chronic illness, or a momentary affliction — none can overcome them. Tumors, eye disease,

swollen limbs, goiter, erysipelas, scrofula, dog-bite wounds, scabies, all forms of leprosy, all forms of swelling, all forms of injury, all bewitching karma, all black magic, and all reanimated corpses — none of these can overcome them either.

Ānanda, these root dhāraṇī mantras were spoken by nine hundred and ninety million buddhas. Whoever transgresses these root dhāraṇī mantras has deceived every single one of them.

Ānanda, whether one who bears these root dhāraṇī mantras sits in a royal palace, one should keep them in mind. If one sits in the midst of thieves, one should keep them in mind. If one sits in the midst of demons, one should keep them in mind. If one sits in the midst of fierce wild beasts, one should keep them in mind. If one sits in a wilderness hermitage, one should keep them in mind. If one is on a difficult river crossing, one should keep them in mind. If one is in the midst of fire, one should keep them in mind. If one is in the midst of water, one should keep them in mind.

For one who keeps them in mind, none of those dangers will arise. And every poison that person has consumed will be transformed into nourishment.

Ānanda, one who bears these root dhāraṇī mantras cannot be overpowered by any elemental spirit (bhūta). They cannot be overpowered by any hungry ghost (preta), any corpse-raiser, any executioner, any act of sorcery, any curse, or any human or non-human being. In brief, Ānanda, no harm of any kind from another can overpower such a person.

Ānanda, one who is worthy of being slain will be freed by a cutting blow. One who is worthy of a cutting blow will be freed by a beating. One who is worthy of a beating will be freed by a thrashing. One who is worthy of a thrashing will be freed by a rebuke. And one who is worthy of a rebuke will be freed by a direct gaze.

Ānanda, I have not seen, in all the world with its gods, its māras, and its Brahmā, among all creatures including ascetics and brahmins, among gods, humans, and asuras, any being who, having been protected, fully guarded, and bound with the full protection of these root dhāraṇī mantras — having been made peaceful and brought to well-being — could afterwards be turned otherwise. Why is that? Because these root dhāraṇī mantras are consecrated with blessing to be definitively free of all harm, contagion, and disturbance.

Then, when this exposition of the Dharma was complete, the Four Great Kings addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, we too wish to propagate this exposition of the Dharma extensively, to fully uphold those who teach the Dharma, to ensure that the sacred Dharma endures for a long time, and to vanquish all māras. We therefore request that the Blessed One graciously grant us these root dhāraṇī mantras with the word 'Excellent.'" Then the Blessed One, out of compassion for the Four Great Kings, granted this by remaining silent. And the Four Great Kings, recognizing that the Blessed One had granted the request by remaining silent, gave voice to their proclamation. It was this:

Daṇḍe, Daṇḍe, Mahādaṇḍe, Jambhane, Stambhane, Ṭaṭe, Ṭaṭane, Mahāṭaṭane, Kuṭṭe, Kuṭṭane, Mahākuṭṭane, Dharmale, Carmale, Svāhā.

"Blessed One, these appear to be words forming the retinue of this dhāraṇī. Whatever son or daughter of good family bears these root dhāraṇī mantras, recites and intones them, and holds them — such a person will, except for previous karma, pass beyond all harm from others, and will come into harmony with all beings. For such a person, no obstacles will arise to upholding all the sacred Dharma."

Then the Blessed One praised the Four Great Kings: "Excellent! Excellent, friends! It is good that you have undertaken this for the sake of ensuring that the teaching endures for a long time."

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, in order that these may become of great miraculous power, great benefit, and great blessing, receive this exposition of the Dharma of dhāraṇī, take it up, commit it to memory, absorb it, master it completely, and teach it extensively to others." Ānanda replied: "Blessed One, I shall receive it in order to propagate it extensively."

Then, in order to explain this very meaning at greater length, the Blessed One at that time declared these verses:

This sūtra of dhāraṇī mantras
has been spoken by all the buddhas.

For the benefit of sentient beings,
I too have taught this.

Whoever holds this sūtra of dhāraṇī mantras,
or recites it —

in twenty-one successive lifetimes
they will remember those lives.

To one who recites these dhāraṇī mantras,
no non-human being whatsoever,
no yakṣa, no kumbhāṇḍa, no rākṣasa,
will ever create an obstacle.

To one who recites these dhāraṇī mantras,
the sinful māra who is lord of the desire realm
will never be able to create an obstacle.

The parents, brothers, sisters,
and close friends and companions
of one who holds these dhāraṇī mantras
will never fall into evil destinies.

Therefore, whoever has heard this sūtra of dhāraṇī mantras
fearlessly,
and who recites these dhāraṇī mantras,
need never be afraid.

Whatever obscuring karma
one who holds these dhāraṇī mantras
has accumulated over ten billion kalpas
will be purified in seven days.

All the merit a bodhisattva
has accomplished over ten billion kalpas —
one who holds these dhāraṇī mantras
will surpass it all in seven days.

The four great kings who protect the world in the four directions,
together with their retinues and ministers,
guarding bodies and territories,
endowed with fine appearance and distinguished birth,
with handsome complexion and renown —
these too will constantly protect
one who recites these dhāraṇī mantras.

After the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Ānanda, those
great śrāvakas, the noble Maitreya, Mañjuśrī, and the other great

This concludes the noble dhāraṇī called the Supreme Lamp, the Queen of Vidyā Mantras.

- The world-system name translated as "Endurance" renders the Tibetan *Mi-mjed*, the standard Tibetan equivalent of *Skt. Sahā*, the name of our world-system presided over by *Śākyamuni*. The word means something like "that which is to be endured" or "the world of forbearance."

The terms "kumbhāṇḍas" and "rākṣasas" are kept in Sanskrit as they are technical names for classes of supernatural beings without standard English equivalents. Kumbhāṇḍas are a class of demonic spirits; rākṣasas are cannibal demons.

- The mantra syllables are transliterated as faithfully as the Tibetan spelling conventions allow. Tibetan orthography for Indic retroflex consonants is inconsistent across manuscripts, and individual syllables may admit alternative readings. The mantra syllables are preserved in their transmitted form rather than normalized.

- The list of disease and malady terms involves some genuine uncertainty. The term rendered "epidemic winds" follows the classical Tibetan medical triad of wind, bile, and phlegm disorders. The term rendered "erysipelas" is a common identification for me dpal, though some commentators gloss it as a skin inflammation more broadly. The term rendered "scrofula" for shu ba and "dog-bite wounds" for khyi rngos follow standard medical glossaries but the precise dermatological conditions intended may vary across traditions.

The shift from fourteen lifetimes in the preceding passage to twenty-one lifetimes here, and from eight hundred and forty million to nine hundred and ninety million buddhas, follows the Tibetan text as given and likely reflects a distinct dhāraṇī section with its own set of benefits.

- The graduated sequence of harms and their lesser punishments — slaying freed by cutting, cutting by beating, beating by thrashing, thrashing by rebuke, rebuke by a direct gaze — reflects a traditional Indian legal and cosmological schema of graduated penalties; the dhāraṇī's power reduces whatever punishment a bearer deserves to a successively milder form, down to a mere glance.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan and are not translated, in keeping with dhāraṇī convention.

- The closing line is a colophon identifying the text as the Āryavidyārājñī Pradīpottama Dhāraṇī. The term "kumbhāṇḍa" renders Tibetan "grulbum," a class of demonic beings in the Buddhist cosmological tradition. "Non-human beings" renders "mi min," a broad category covering all non-human spirits and entities capable of causing harm. The phrase "fall into evil destinies" for "logpar ltungbar" refers to rebirth in the lower realms of hell-beings, hungry ghosts, and animals.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.